

infrastructure creation and telecommunications. “He [Modi] has been a role model for many of us around the world with Digital India, and how he brings those benefits to every citizen across the country,” John T. Chambers, Chairman of US-India Strategic Partnership Forum, and Chairman Emeritus of Cisco, said in a statement. Further, Boeing—that recently finalised an order for 290 passenger jets with Air India—has reiterated its support for the rapid expansion of the country’s commercial aviation market and modernisation of the defence forces. “We support PM Modi’s Make in India initiative, with more than 5,000 people in India pursuing high-quality careers doing innovative work on the Boeing team. Our growing investments in India underscore not only the strength of Boeing’s partnership with the nation, but also the positive trajectory of the broader US-India economic relationship,” said CEO Dave Calhoun in a statement shared with *BT*. The PM also discussed investments with a number of CEOs, including Sanjay Mehrotra (Micron Technology); Tim Cook (Apple); Sundar Pichai (Google and Alphabet); Satya Nadella (Microsoft); Gary E. Dickerson (Applied Materials); H. Lawrence Culp, Jr. (GE); and Elon Musk (Tesla).

At the height of the Cold War in the 1970s, the Richard Nixon administration—which had adopted a hawkish stance towards a democratic India then—was cosyng up to communist China by deploying what came to be known as ping-pong diplomacy. On the first day of his visit, Modi led a session with participants from 135 countries on the occasion of the 9th International Day of Yoga on June 21, 2023, at the UN headquarters in New York. This exercise in yoga diplomacy serves as an apt metaphor for the ongoing geopolitical shift, where the US sees India as a strong bulwark against an increasingly belligerent China in the Indo-Pacific. **BT**

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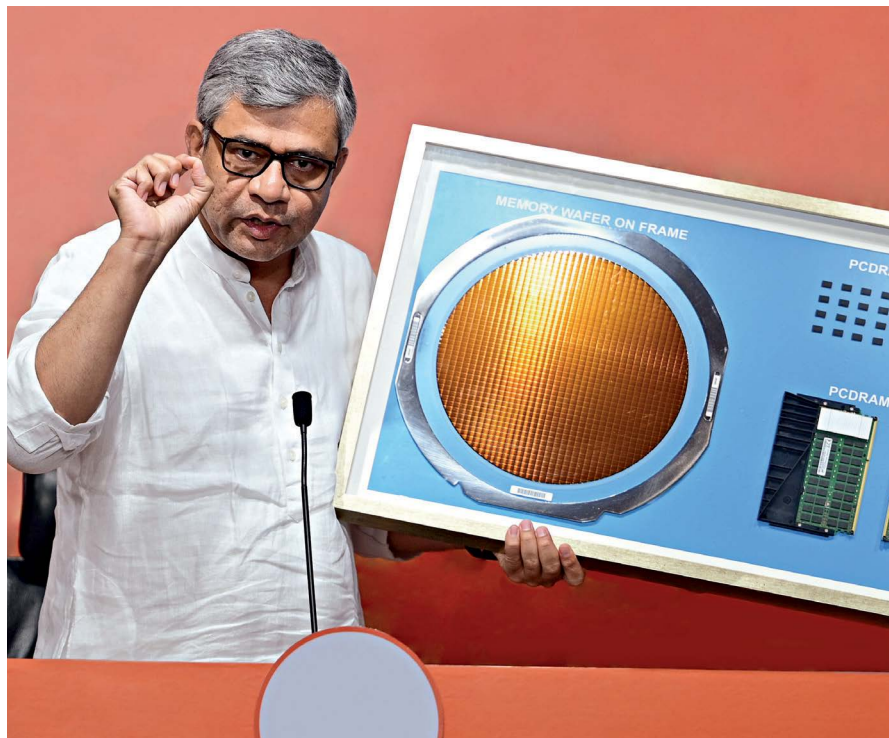
SEMICONDUCTORS

Chip Dreams

While investments in the semiconductor space have been welcomed, persistence will be key

BY NIDHI SINGAL

PHOTO BY MANISH RAJPUT



LAYING THE GROUNDWORK Right before Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s US visit, Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw (pictured) made a three-day trip to meet leading stakeholders in the semiconductor ecosystem

► **EXACTLY ONE YEAR**, five months, and 22 days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s Cabinet unveiled the production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme to boost the semiconductor ecosystem in India, news came of a company committing to build a \$2.7-billion assembly and testing unit in Gujarat. This isn’t the first such application received under the scheme. What makes it special is the company involved:

US-headquartered Micron Technology, which makes its own chips and packages, tests them, and directly sells to electronics product companies.

More importantly, Micron will enable assembly and testing of both DRAM (dynamic random-access memory) and NAND flash memory products, which can practically go into every type of use case from mobiles to laptops, cars, data centres and